PRE-PURCHASE INSPECTION CHECKLIST

Nissan Patrol Y60 (GQ)

1987–1997 · Y60 · GQ · GR · Safari

BOXYTRUCKS

CHECK BEFORE YOU BUY

- [ ] **Rust first, everything else second**
  Forum veterans check the roof gutters, the sliding rear-window frames, the door sills and jambs, the front guards, the backs of the rear wheel arches and the upper firewall. Lift the rear carpets too, because sand under the mats can eat the floor pans. A freshly painted GQ can be hiding gutter and rear-quarter rust.

- [ ] **Look for oil on the swivel hubs**
  Greasy gunk on the front swivels usually means the inner axle seal has failed and diff oil is getting past swivel seals that were never designed to hold oil. That's a front-axle teardown, so price it in. Look for oil on the brake backing plates as well, a sign of worn axle seals. CarsGuide adds that leaks from the rear diff seals are common on GQs, though regular servicing usually cures them.

- [ ] **Drive it at 70–80 km/h (45–50 mph)**
  Early GQs suffered a front-end shimmy at about 70–80 km/h. Most were fixed under warranty by removing knuckle shims to take out free play, but a worn truck can bring it back. Owners also report shakes around 110 km/h, so test at highway speed and check the tie rods, panhard rod and radius-arm bushes.

- [ ] **Know which engine, and which rocker cover**
  The TD42 is the safe bet if it has been kept cool. A silver rocker cover means a pre-August-1993 engine, from before Nissan lightened it. Petrol TB42s and turbo RD28Ts have a history of head problems when worked hard. Ask about the cooling system, look for milky oil and coolant stains, and walk away from a truck that 'just needs a head gasket'.

- [ ] **Open and close every door**
  If a door drops when you open it, the hinge pins are worn, a well-known GQ problem. Wikipedia also records cracking rear-door hinges from the weight of the spare. Both are fixable with hinge-pin kits or new genuine hinges, but they tell you how hard the truck has been used.

- [ ] **Test 4WD in high and low range**
  Check that the free-wheeling hubs lock and unlock smoothly, then drive in 4H and 4L on dirt. One forum tip is a tight circle in low range, which should scrub the tyres. Listen for gearbox whine or clunks, check that it doesn't jump out of gear on overrun, and inspect the gearbox crossmember for rock damage. Wikipedia also records fifth-gear bearing failures in high-mileage European five-speeds.

- [ ] **Be wary of automatics**
  Members of the NissanPatrol.com.au forum report trouble with GQ automatics, with rebuilds around A$3,000. The auto's cooler also sits inside the radiator, so a truck that overheats can cook its transmission too. A manual with a service history is the conservative choice.

- [ ] **If it's lifted, check the details**
  On lifted GQs, confirm that the brake lines were extended, the rear load-proportioning valve was adjusted, and caster was corrected with offset radius-arm bushes. Bent rear lower control arms and stone-damaged rods suggest it has been driven hard.

IS IT THE REAL THING?

- [ ] **Four names, one truck**
  Y60 is Nissan's series code. Australians call it the GQ, Europe calls it the Patrol GR, and Japan sold it as the Safari. Ford Australia sold a rebadged version as the Maverick from 1988 to 1994.
- [ ] **Japanese chassis codes**
  Codes seen on Japanese catalogues and preserved trucks include VRY60 (short hardtop, 2,400 mm wheelbase), VRGY60 (long 'Extra Van' and Granroad, 2,970 mm), WGY60 (Kingsroad extra-high-roof wagon), WYY60 (RD28T short hardtop, e.g. Spirit Type II) and UY60 (Australian cab-chassis).
- [ ] **Which TD42**
  Early naturally aspirated TD42s have a silver rocker cover ('Silvertop'). Turbo engines and later lightened engines are black ('Blacktop'). Owners prefer the early engine, so check before you pay Silvertop money.
- [ ] **Lockers and winch**
  Most Y60s have a rear limited-slip diff. Some have a vacuum- or electric-solenoid rear diff lock, and some have a PTO-driven front winch with a control lever to the right of the gear stick. Look for the switch and the lever rather than trusting the ad.
- [ ] **24-volt Safaris**
  Japanese Safaris were available with a 24 V electrical system instead of 12 V. That matters for every bulb, starter and accessory you buy, so check which one you have.

- [ ] **Market tells**
  Spanish-built European trucks are left-hand drive and kept their rear lamps in the body. Australian trucks moved them into the bumper from 1991, and from 1994 they gained extra indicators on the front quarter panels.

NOTES

From the full guide at https://boxytrucks.com/models/nissan-patrol/y60/, with sources. Recalls follow the VIN: check at nhtsa.gov/recalls. General information only, not a professional inspection; see boxytrucks.com/about/disclaimer/. © BoxyTrucks